

Administrative

1. [Submission deadline](#): 1 July 2026.

I ask you to follow up with me once every other week in May, then once weekly in June. We may need to meet more frequently in the last week for the final touches.

2. [Submission guidelines](#): IEEE conference format.

Please use the LaTeX template and **share the project with me on Overleaf**. My account is hazemelalfy@gmail.com

I will follow up on your manuscript draft as it evolves.

3. I will also ask you from time to time to show me a demo of your code, loss curves, intermediate results, etc. Please **share your GitHub repo with me**. My ID, as expected, is also: hazemelalfy

Scientific

For a paper to be accepted to a high-quality conference like DICTA, it should make a tangible contribution. This is what top conferences ask their reviewers to look for in a paper:

"Is it clear how this work differs from previous contributions, with relevant citations provided? Does this work offer a novel combination of existing techniques, and is the reasoning behind this combination well-articulated? Originality does not necessarily require introducing an entirely new method; rather, a work that provides novel insights."

Broadly, I suggest contributions across three areas:

1. **Engineering**: Include a novel model architecture (it could be as simple as adding modules to an existing backbone, or combining multiple architectures, but it can be a more novel full architecture), or an efficient pipeline to improve latency, or both! I believe the code you have already started in this direction.
2. **Theory**: Include a novel theoretical component (mathematical), such as a novel loss function or metric. Just adding a parameter is very marginal. It should be a justified "significant" change. I think that was one of your strongest contributions: the loss function. However, you did not justify your empirical choice of parameters, which is a clear weakness.
3. **Practice**: Evaluate your model on three benchmarks or conduct an extensive evaluation on two benchmarks. This is one of the very few groups that transferred their trained model to a second dataset. That is good. However, SOTA comparison on either dataset is clearly missing.

In order to achieve those contributions, you need to perform a more careful literature review, not only on the overall impainting problem, but with a special focus on your main contribution near boundaries, or seams, as they call it. Based on this focused literature survey, each time you present one of your novel contributions, you will not only say: "we did so and so". Instead, you would say **why** you did so and so, and **how it is different** from the latest literature, or **what it adds** to the current literature.

I have run your file on the [Stanford Agentic AI](#) tool developed by Andrew Ng. Even though it is AI, I have reviewed it myself and find that it is highly relevant. If you follow its suggestions, you are almost guaranteed to be accepted to DICTA 2026. This is not a surprise since it was trained on the reviews of the top machine learning conference ICLR. If you really have to miss a suggestion from the Agentic AI feedback, ensure that the remaining ones cover all three areas: Engineering, Theory and Practice.